

Lime Shield, ship checklist

Everything left between today and a submitted App Store build. Written 15 September 2026.

Where you already are

These are finished. Nothing below asks you to redo them.

- App name reserved, bundle identifier com.limeshield.LimeShield, Apple ID 6811397021.
- Privacy policy and support pages live on GitHub Pages.
- App Store listing written and entered: name, subtitle, promotional text, keywords, description, category.
- Screenshots shot at 6.9 inch and uploaded.
- App Privacy questionnaire answered, declaring Purchase History only.
- Paid Apps Agreement active, legal entity and tax forms complete.
- RevenueCat wired end to end. The offering points at the App Store product, the paywall renders the real 2.99 price, and a sandbox purchase completed successfully on your phone.

That last item was the hard part. Everything from here is forms and buttons.

1 Enable Sign in with Apple

Your app has a Sign in with Apple button and your privacy policy describes optional sign-in, but the capability is not enabled on the target. Right now that button fails with the fallback error we wrote. A reviewer who taps it sees a broken feature, and your privacy policy describes something that is not really there.

In Xcode, select the LimeShield target, open Signing and Capabilities, click the plus Capability button at the top left, type sign, and double click Sign in with Apple. Xcode updates the App ID for you because you have a paid developer account.

Then run the app and tap the sign-in button. You want the real Apple sheet, not the error.

If it refuses to add for any reason, the fallback is to remove the sign-in button from the app and delete the optional sign-in paragraph from the privacy policy. Enabling it is cleaner.

2 Add the export compliance key

Apple asks an encryption question on every single upload. You can answer it once in the app instead of every time.

Open Info.plist and add a new row. Key: `ITSAppUsesNonExemptEncryption`. Type: Boolean. Value: NO.

That is accurate for Lime Shield. The only encryption you touch is standard HTTPS to RevenueCat, which is exempt. Add this before archiving and the question never appears.

3 Set the version numbers

In the General tab of the LimeShield target, confirm Version reads 1.0 and Build reads 1. If Build is blank, type 1.

Version is what customers see. Build is an internal counter that has to increase every time you upload. If you ever upload a second time for the same version, bump Build to 2, not the Version.

4 Fill in the subscription review information

In App Store Connect open your app, then Subscriptions in the sidebar, then your subscription group, then Pro Monthly.

Localizations

Confirm these are filled in. Apple will not accept the submission without them.

- Display Name: Lime Shield Pro
- Description: Unlimited bill scans and unlimited letters

Review Information

Scroll to the bottom of the page. Upload the screenshot of your Premium tab, the one showing the 2.99 subscribe button. Then paste this into the review notes field.

Tap the Premium tab in the bottom bar to reach this screen. No account or login is required. The subscription unlocks unlimited scans and unlimited letters. All bill analysis runs on-device with no network calls.

5 Complete the age rating

On the app's main page, find the Age Rating row under General Information or App Information and click Edit.

It is a questionnaire of roughly fifteen dropdowns. Answer None or No to every one. Lime Shield has no violence, no gambling, no sexual content, no user generated content, no unrestricted web access, no medical treatment information. You should land on 4+.

If it gives you anything other than 4+, you answered something yes by accident. Go back and check.

6 Archive the build

In the device selector at the top of the Xcode window, where it currently names a simulator, click it and choose Any iOS Device (arm64). It sits near the top of that list, above the simulators.

You cannot archive with a simulator selected. The Archive menu item stays greyed out. This is the single most common place people get stuck.

Then Product menu, Archive. It builds in release mode, which takes longer than a normal run, usually two to five minutes. The Organizer window opens by itself when it finishes.

The nine Swift 6 main actor warnings are harmless and do not block anything.

7 Upload to App Store Connect

With your archive selected in the Organizer, click Distribute App on the right. Choose App Store Connect, then Upload. Take the defaults on the options screen, including uploading symbols, and let Xcode manage signing automatically.

You want to see Upload Successful. After that the build processes on Apple's side for roughly ten to thirty minutes. You get an email either way, and if something is wrong with the binary the email says exactly what.

8 Attach the build and the subscription

Once processing finishes, open version 1.0 in App Store Connect and scroll to the Build section. Click Add Build and pick build 1.

While you are on that page, find the In-App Purchases or Subscriptions section and make sure Pro Monthly is selected there.

Your first subscription has to be submitted together with the app version. It does not go through on its own. This is the second most common cause of a rejection at this stage.

9 Submit

Work down the version page and confirm no section shows a yellow warning triangle. Screenshots, description, keywords, support URL, privacy policy URL, age rating, app privacy, build, subscription.

When it is clean, the Add for Review button at the top right becomes active. Click it, then confirm on the summary screen.

What happens after

The status moves to Waiting for Review, usually for less than a day now, then In Review, then either Approved or Rejected with a note explaining why.

Most first-time rejections are small and fixable in an hour. The usual causes, in rough order of likelihood for an app like yours:

- A feature the reviewer could not reach. Your review notes already point them at the Sample button on the home screen, which is why that note matters.
- The subscription not attached to the version, covered in step 8.
- A broken button, which is why step 1 matters.
- Guideline 2.1 requests for more information. These are a question, not a refusal. Answer in Resolution Center and they continue.

If you are rejected, you do not start over. You fix the item, reply in Resolution Center, and if it needed a code change you archive again with Build 2 and resubmit.

Timeline

Shipaton closes on 30 September. If you upload by 20 September you have ten days of slack, which is enough room for one rejection and a resubmit without any panic. The twentieth is a buffer, not an estimate of how long the work takes. Steps 1 through 9 above are about two hours of actual clicking.

Still open after submission

These are not blockers for shipping, but they are on the older plan and worth picking back up once the build is in review.

- Test against real medical bills from the household.
- The sixteen rules that have never fired in testing.
- The airplane mode privacy demo, which is your strongest single piece of marketing.
- Sourced reference prices rather than ballpark figures.
- TestFlight for outside testers.
- Build in public posts and the Devpost submission, which Shipaton judges separately from the app.